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Alexander Bustrup's quotes

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“Economics is not a science of wealth, whatever its textbooks say on their first page; it is a science of choices made under scarcity, and the moment a student grasps that the subject stops



being about money at all and becomes about what a person is willing to give up. Every price is a sentence about somebody's preferences, written in the only language large groups of strangers have ever agreed on. Read enough of them and a market begins to look less like a machine and more like a conversation nobody is chairing."

— *Fixture Author 102, Notes on Scarcity*

tags: [economics](#), [choice](#), [value](#)

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"An argument you cannot state in your opponent's own words is an argument you have not yet understood. (Fixture entry 200.)"

— *Fixture Author 200*

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"The ledger is honest about everything except what was worth doing, and that is the only entry anyone remembers. (Fixture entry 201.)"

— *Fixture Author 201, A Sample Work, Number 201*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-5](#)

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"Patience is a technique before it is a virtue: it is the practice of leaving a question open long enough for it to answer itself. (Fixture entry 202.)"

— *Fixture Author 202, A Sample Work, Number 202*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-6](#)

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"It is not from the benevolence of the butcher, the brewer, or the baker that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest."

— *Adam Smith, The Wealth of Nations*

tags: [economics](#), [self-interest](#)

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"Every institution begins as a solution to a problem and ends as a description of the people who work in it, which is why reform is so much harder than founding, and why the founders are so much better remembered than the reformers who kept the thing alive. (Fixture entry 203.)"

— *Fixture Author 203, A Sample Work, Number 203*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-0](#)

311 likes [Like](#)



"Attention is the rarest form of generosity, and it cannot be faked for very long. (Fixture entry 204.)"

— *Fixture Author 204, A Sample Work, Number 204*

348 likes [Like](#)

"Nothing is so practical as a good theory, and nothing is so useless as a theory that has never once been embarrassed by a fact. (Fixture entry 205.)"

— *Fixture Author 205*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-2](#)

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"The whole problem with the world is that fools and fanatics are always so certain of themselves, and wiser people so full of doubts."

— *Bertrand Russell*

5120 likes [Like](#)



"To study something is to agree in advance to be corrected by it. (Fixture entry 206.)"

— *Fixture Author 206, A Sample Work, Number 206*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-3](#)

422 likes [Like](#)



"A market clears; it does not thereby become just. The two words describe different questions, and a great deal of bad argument comes from answering the first while appearing to answer the second. (Fixture entry 207.)"

— *Fixture Author 207, A Sample Work, Number 207*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-4](#)

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"The first duty of a student is to find out what he actually believes, which usually takes longer than finding out what is true. (Fixture entry 208.)"

— *Fixture Author 208, A Sample Work, Number 208*

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"He asked me, "And what do you plan to do with a philosophy degree?" ... I said that I planned to notice things."

— *Fixture Author 103, Small Conversations*

tags: [study](#)

7 likes [Like](#)



"Boredom is the raw material of thought, and we have industrialised its removal. (Fixture entry 209.)"

— *Fixture Author 209, A Sample Work, Number 209*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-6](#)

533 likes [Like](#)



"An argument you cannot state in your opponent's own words is an argument you have not yet understood. (Fixture entry 210.)"

— *Fixture Author 210*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-0](#)

570 likes [Like](#)



"The ledger is honest about everything except what was worth doing, and that is the only entry anyone remembers. (Fixture entry 211.)"

— *Fixture Author 211, A Sample Work, Number 211*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-1](#)

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"Two things fill the mind with ever new and increasing admiration and awe: the starry heavens above me and the moral law within me."

— *Immanuel Kant, Critique of Practical Reason*

tags: [ethics](#), [wonder](#)

1402 likes [Like](#)



"Patience is a technique before it is a virtue: it is the practice of leaving a question open long enough for it to answer itself. (Fixture entry 212.)"

— *Fixture Author 212, A Sample Work, Number 212*

644 likes [Like](#)



"Every institution begins as a solution to a problem and ends as a description of the people who work in it, which is why reform is so much harder than founding, and why the founders are so much better remembered than the reformers who kept the thing alive. (Fixture entry 213.)"

— *Fixture Author 213, A Sample Work, Number 213*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-3](#)

681 likes [Like](#)



"Attention is the rarest form of generosity, and it cannot be faked for very long. (Fixture entry 214.)"

— *Fixture Author 214, A Sample Work, Number 214*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-4](#)

718 likes [Like](#)



"Freedom is not worth having if it does not include the freedom to make mistakes."

— *Mahatma Gandhi*

tags: [freedom](#)

2088 likes [Like](#)



"Nothing is so practical as a good theory, and nothing is so useless as a theory that has never once been embarrassed by a fact. (Fixture entry 215.)"

— *Fixture Author 215*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-5](#)

755 likes [Like](#)



"To study something is to agree in advance to be corrected by it. (Fixture entry 216.)"

— *Fixture Author 216, A Sample Work, Number 216*

792 likes [Like](#)



"A market clears; it does not thereby become just. The two words describe different questions, and a great deal of bad argument comes from answering the first while appearing to answer the second. (Fixture entry 217.)"

— *Fixture Author 217, A Sample Work, Number 217*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-0](#)

829 likes [Like](#)



"The first duty of a student is to find out what he actually believes, which usually takes longer than finding out what is true. (Fixture entry 218.)"

— *Fixture Author 218, A Sample Work, Number 218*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-1](#)

866 likes [Like](#)



"Boredom is the raw material of thought, and we have industrialised its removal. (Fixture entry 219.)"

— *Fixture Author 219, A Sample Work, Number 219*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-2](#)

3 likes [Like](#)



"An argument you cannot state in your opponent's own words is an argument you have not yet understood. (Fixture entry 220.)"

— *Fixture Author 220*

40 likes [Like](#)



"The ledger is honest about everything except what was worth doing, and that is the only entry anyone remembers. (Fixture entry 221.)"

— *Fixture Author 221, A Sample Work, Number 221*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-4](#)

77 likes [Like](#)



"Patience is a technique before it is a virtue: it is the practice of leaving a question open long enough for it to answer itself. (Fixture entry 222.)"

— *Fixture Author 222, A Sample Work, Number 222*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-5](#)

114 likes [Like](#)



"Every institution begins as a solution to a problem and ends as a description of the people who work in it, which is why reform is so much harder than founding, and why the founders are so much better remembered than the reformers who kept the thing alive. (Fixture entry 223.)"

— *Fixture Author 223, A Sample Work, Number 223*

tags: [fixture](#), [set-6](#)

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